



Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Senegal and Gambia Advance Digital Cooperation on Connectivity, Cybersecurity — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

SENEGAL

GAMBIA

Senegal's Minister of Telecommunications and Digital Affairs, Samba Diouf, visited Banjul to review the implementation roadmap for the telecommunications and digital-development memorandum of understanding signed between Senegal and The Gambia. Connectivity, cybersecurity, capacity building and digital transformation were named as the areas discussed, with initiatives to be advanced according to readiness; no first projects, funding or timetable are stated. *Also under [Connectivity](#).*

Nigeria Pushes Sovereign AI Agenda at GITEX 2026 — Voice of Nigeria, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria set out a sovereign-AI agenda at a government leadership summit in Abuja, the technology agency's director-general arguing that sovereignty must cover the whole stack - connectivity, compute, data centres, cloud and models. The Secretary to the Government put figures behind it: a cloud policy targeting US\$750m of private cloud and data-centre investment within 24 months, 90,000 km of planned fibre, and a talent programme at about 1.87 million registrations. *Also under [AI](#), [Data Storage](#), [Digital Identity and CRVS](#) and [Training and skills](#).*

Namibia advances national digital trust framework — ITWeb Africa, 31 August 2026

NAMIBIA

Namibia's Communications Regulatory Authority and the German identity supplier Veridos signed an implementation agreement with the Ministry of Home Affairs, Immigration, Safety and Security for a national public key infrastructure. CRAN acts as national Root Certification Authority and the ministry becomes the first Certification Service Provider, issuing electronic IDs — the base for digital identity, electronic signatures and identity verification in government services. No timetable or cost is stated.

Legislation and regulation

Unlicensed SA finfluencers face enforcement action — ITWeb South Africa, 31 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's Financial Sector Conduct Authority named unlicensed financial advice on social media one of its highest enforcement priorities, its enforcement head Gerhard van Deventer telling a Regulatory Actions Report roundtable that operating through a platform is no exemption from the licensing law and that penalties have already been imposed on finfluencers. He drew a distinction between financial education and regulated advice, and said the regulator is also looking for a way to engage finfluencers on where that line falls.

Nigeria wants crypto firms to lock up 80% of customer assets offline — TechCabal, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria's Securities and Exchange Commission opened for comment on 20 August a framework requiring digital-asset firms to segregate customer funds from their own, notify the regulator of material incidents within 24 hours and file a detailed report within 48. Minimum paid-up capital would be ₦2 billion (about \$1.5m) for exchanges and custodians, ₦500 million for platform operators, offering platforms and tokenisation platforms, and ₦200 million for virtual asset service providers, each backed by a fidelity insurance bond covering at least a quarter of that. The rules also require a share of customer assets to be held in offline cold storage and SEC approval before a foreign-issued stablecoin may be listed.

Kenya : le Parlement veut rétablir les sanctions contre les fausses informations en ligne — wearetech.africa, 31 August 2026 KENYA

Kenya's National Assembly has asked the Supreme Court to overturn a Court of Appeal ruling that struck down sections 22 and 23 of the 2018 Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act, which criminalised knowingly publishing false or misleading data presented as authentic, with penalties up to KES 5 million (about \$38,600) and, for some offences, ten years' imprisonment. The Court of Appeal held the wording too broad, capable of catching people who share content unaware it is false as well as journalists and ordinary users; Parliament argues the provisions reach neither opinion, satire nor good-faith error.

InfoReg concerned by 'alarming' rate of data breaches — ITWeb, 31 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's Information Regulator has received more than 8,000 security-compromise reports to date, 1,220 of them since April, a rate its chairperson called very alarming and expects to pass 3,000 for the financial year. It served an enforcement notice on the national bureau of standards over a 2024 ransomware attack, and referred two direct-marketing matters to its enforcement committee. *Also under [Data protection](#).*

Guinée : la 12e Assemblée générale des régulateurs de l'audiovisuel s'ouvre sur fond de lutte contre la désinformation — Africa Guinée, 31 August 2026 GUINEA

The 12th General Assembly of the audiovisual regulators' platform of the eight UEMOA states and Guinea opened in Conakry, and its presidency passed to Guinea. The two-day agenda was harmonising the legal and technical tools for regulating social platforms against cybersecurity and social-cohesion risks, AI-generated disinformation and deepfakes among them. *Also under [Regional collaboration](#) and [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).*

Defending the Fourth Estate against uncurbed digital platforms — Business Day, 31 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

A named-analyst column argues South Africa's competition inquiry into media and digital platforms treated the platforms as an economic problem to be metered rather than as media institutions to be held to account, extracting R688m for local publishers from one platform while leaving another largely untouched on editorial conduct. The inquiry found 77% of respondents relied primarily on social media for news. *Also under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).*

Cyberespace et libertés d'expression : le Garde des Sceaux appelle à 'réguler sans censurer', mais... — Africa Guinée, 31 August 2026 GUINEA

Opening the regulators' assembly in Conakry, Guinea's Justice Minister argued for a framework that protects without stifling and regulates without censoring, and called cybersecurity a question of sovereignty rather than a technical one. *Also under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).*

Data protection

InfoReg concerned by 'alarming' rate of data breaches — ITWeb, 31 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Regional collaboration

Le Gabon s'inspire du modèle rwandais pour accélérer sa transformation numérique — wearetech.africa, 31

August 2026

GABON

RWANDA

A Gabonese Interior Ministry delegation spent nearly two weeks in Kigali studying Rwanda's e-government, digital identity, cybersecurity and public-service digitisation. Gabon is preparing its own government services portal: interministerial consultations for the pilot opened in June 2026 across five ministries, with at least ten services to be integrated by December. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#) and [Digital Identity and CRVS](#).*

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GUINEA

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Public debate and participation in policymaking

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Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Cyberespace et libertés d'expression : le Garde des Sceaux appelle à 'réguler sans censurer', mais... — Africa Guinée, 31 August 2026

GUINEA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Finance

New investments

What 10 years and \$100M taught TLcom about scaling in Africa — TechCabal, 31 August 2026

A partner at an Africa-focused venture firm managing over \$250m argues that African venture is compounding rather than stalling: the building blocks for building and scaling companies are more solidly in place than a decade ago, which changes what investors can reasonably underwrite. It is an argument about conditions, made against three years of commentary about what the market lacks. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

Mamor Capital raises R300m for SA tech start-ups — ITWeb South Africa, 31 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

A black women-owned South African venture firm reached a R300 million (\$18.8 million) first close on its inaugural fund, anchored by the state asset manager, against a R550 million target. It will back post-revenue South African technology companies. Its founder says the raise took more than three years and that institutional appetite for venture capital in the country is still developing. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

Mamor Capital raises \$18.8 million first fund — TechCabal, 31 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

A second account of the same first close puts the gap the fund targets more precisely: companies with paying customers that are still too small or too risky for a bank loan, in a market where limited exits and thin follow-on funding remain the barriers. Southern Africa recorded R13.35 billion across 1,325 deals in 2024. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

La fintech Nomba et Synafare s'allient pour doter 300 PME nigérianes d'énergie solaire — wearetech.africa, 31 August 2026 NIGERIA

A Nigerian fintech and an energy company announced a \$1.4 million partnership to finance solar installations for 300 small and medium enterprises, lending directly for batteries and inverters. The stated aim is to cut costly generator use and give businesses stable power. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [Energy](#).*

L'entreprise égyptienne Swvl lève des fonds pour s'implanter aux États-Unis — wearetech.africa, 31 August 2026

EGYPT

The Egyptian mobility company Swvl agreed a \$1.5 million investment with Sofico Holdings, taking its recent raising to \$14.5 million. The company says the capital will fund day-to-day working needs and accelerate its expansion into the United States market. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Starlink Is Live in Equatorial Guinea — Space in Africa, 31 August 2026 EQ. GUINEA

Starlink went live in Equatorial Guinea on 29 August, its 30th African market, with a consumer order page and residential tariffs in CFA francs. The entry is not a permanent licence: it runs under a provisional approval granted by Vice-President Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue on 29 July, with the state infrastructure company GITGE assessing operations and deciding what regulatory conditions should apply longer term. An earlier framework had confined authorised access largely to oil, gas and strategic infrastructure, and whether that restriction survives the review period is unresolved.

Internet par satellite : Starlink cible 16 nouveaux marchés africains d'ici fin 2026 — Agence Ecofin, 31 August 2026

MAURITANIA

MALI

GAMBIA

GUINEA

BURKINA FASO

TOGO

TUNISIA

UGANDA

TANZANIA

COMOROS

NAMIBIA

ANGOLA

CONGO

GABON

CAMEROON

MAURITIUS

Starlink's availability map lists 16 further African markets from 2026 - Mauritania, Mali, Gambia, Guinea, Burkina Faso, Togo, Tunisia, Uganda, Tanzania, Comoros, Namibia, Angola, Congo, Gabon, Cameroon and Mauritius - with no launch dates and regulatory approval pending. Eight of them had been listed for 2025 and the service is still unavailable there, which is the more useful half of the notice. *Also under [US / hyperscaler activities](#).*

BTC steps into Botswana's 5G race — ITWeb Africa, 31 August 2026 BOTSWANA

Botswana Telecommunications Corporation will invest more than P240 million (US\$17.8 million) in 2026/27 to accelerate 5G, expand 4G coverage and upgrade capacity, targeting a commercial 5G launch in parts of Gaborone by October. That would make it the third Botswanan operator on 5G, the other two live since 2022. Population coverage stands at 97% for 2G and 4G and 62% for 3G.

Senegal and Gambia Advance Digital Cooperation on Connectivity, Cybersecurity — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026 SENEGAL GAMBIA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

Data Storage

NITDA and Infracorp Strengthen Collaboration on Nigeria's Sovereign Cloud Agenda — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026 NIGERIA

NITDA's director-general Kashifu Inuwa received Infracorp chief executive Lazarus Angbazo for talks on Nigeria's sovereign cloud agenda, focused on operationalising the Investment Strategy — unlocking local funding, increasing private-sector participation and attracting foreign investment into sovereign cloud and digital infrastructure. No commitment, sum or project is attached to the meeting.

Huawei Launches Agentic AI Cloud in Nigeria to Accelerate AI Adoption — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Huawei launched its Agentic AI Cloud in Nigeria at a summit in Lagos on 27 August, presenting local cloud infrastructure with data residency and low latency as a base for deploying AI agents in finance, telecommunications, government and enterprise. It follows the company's first hyperscale local cloud in Nigeria in 2024 and an industry-focused expansion in 2025. NITDA's director-general Kashifu Inuwa Abdullahi placed it against the National Sovereign Cloud Initiative and the country's ambition to move from consuming technology to hosting AI and cloud innovation. *Also under [AI](#).*

Hot startup of the month: Nigeria's Chassis — Connecting Africa, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

A profile of a Nigerian cloud startup building domestic GPU infrastructure rather than reselling foreign compute, aimed at AI model training, real-time fraud detection for fintechs and generative applications. It is positioned against hyperscale data centres and telecom-backed GPU deployments racing to meet the same demand. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

Nigeria Pushes Sovereign AI Agenda at GITEX 2026 — Voice of Nigeria, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

Energy

La fintech Nomba et Synafare s'allient pour doter 300 PME nigérianes d'énergie solaire — wearetech.africa, 31 August 2026 NIGERIA

Summarised under [New investments](#).

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

Cameroon restarts birth registration drive, using schools as gateway to legal identity — Biometric Update, 31 August 2026 CAMEROON

Cameroon will restart special mobile court hearings from September to deliver declaratory birth judgments to one million primary-school pupils holding no birth certificate, after an August assessment found a drive launched in 2024 far from its target. Regional officials were ordered on 26 August to submit pupils' files to the courts before 15 September. The law requires a court judgment wherever the 90-day registration deadline was missed.

Nigeria Pushes Sovereign AI Agenda at GITEX 2026 — Voice of Nigeria, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

Le Gabon s'inspire du modèle rwandais pour accélérer sa transformation numérique — wearetech.africa, 31

August 2026

GABON

RWANDA

Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Digital Payments and Fintech

TTCL and ZFF Launch Digital Push With N-Card E-Ticketing System — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

TANZANIA

Tanzania Telecommunications Corporation and the Zanzibar Football Federation signed a sponsorship and partnership agreement in Zanzibar on 30 August to introduce e-ticketing at football stadiums through TTCL's N-Card platform. The agreement is also said to cover the federation's wider digital systems and football administration; no value, term or start date for the ticketing service is given.

Samsung SA expands digital wallet ecosystem — ITWeb South Africa, 31 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

Samsung South Africa added Scan to Pay QR-code payments, provided by EFT Corp, to Samsung Wallet, four years after launching the wallet locally in November 2022. The company puts Scan to Pay at more than 600,000 acceptance locations in South Africa and inside over 19 million banking, fintech and financial-services app installations; no figure for Samsung Wallet's own local user base is given.

NSSF and Airtel Money Renew Partnership to Expand Voluntary Savings in Uganda — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

UGANDA

Uganda's National Social Security Fund renewed its partnership with Airtel Money to expand voluntary savings through the Smartlife Flexi service, which the fund says lets savers contribute from UGX 500 by mobile phone from any location. No subscriber count, balance or contribution volume is published for it. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

MTN MoMo Uganda and SchoolPay Mark 10 Years of Digital School Fees Payment Partnership — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

UGANDA

MTN MoMo Uganda marked ten years of its partnership with SchoolPay Uganda for digital school-fee payment, and handed the SchoolPay team a van at the anniversary event. Neither party gives transaction volumes, fee value or the number of schools and parents using the channel.

Looping Binary Launches LBPAY Digital Payment Ecosystem in Cameroon — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

CAMEROON

Cameroon-based Looping Binary launched LBPAY, a payments platform for transfers, wallet management and moving money between mobile money networks, with bill and airtime payment alongside. It also offers payment links, developer tools and APIs for businesses integrating payments; the company says Cameroon is the initial market with the intention of scaling elsewhere in Africa, and no licensing or partner-institution detail is given.

Le Béninois Phital Azah transforme WhatsApp et Mobile Money en leviers de vente — wearetech.africa, 31 August 2026

BENIN

A profile of Beninese developer Phital Azah, founder of Xèdo, a 2024 company whose platform lets merchants build an online shop by importing a WhatsApp Business catalogue with its photos, descriptions and prices, then centralise orders. It automates WhatsApp notifications through payment and delivery, chases abandoned baskets, settles by Mobile Money or cash on delivery, and carries an analytics dashboard. Azah is also lead mobile developer at Benin's Commission électorale nationale autonome.

Côte d'Ivoire : ANKA relance sa place de marché grand public sous le nom d'Afrikrea — wearetech.africa, 31

August 2026

CÔTE D'IVOIRE

ANKA has separated its businesses at its tenth anniversary and relaunched its consumer marketplace under the Afrikrea name, through which African and diaspora creators sell fashion, art and crafts internationally with cross-border payment and delivery handled on the platform. What the remaining ANKA business now covers is not stated in the report.

Card-issuing fintech Allawee folds into Paystack after quiet acquisition — TechCabal, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria's largest payment processor acquired card-issuing fintech Allawee in a 2025 deal never publicly announced, and Allawee will close its business and personal account services on 1 December 2026. Balances, account numbers, transaction history and verification records will not carry over. It is the third brand folded in this year, after a business-banking startup and a microfinance bank bought for its licence. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

Banco BCS and Mastercard Partner to Expand Digital Payment Services in Angola — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

ANGOLA

Banco BCS and Mastercard announced a collaboration to expand card and digital payments in Angola, covering Mastercard-enabled debit and credit products, a rollout of contactless payments and improved e-commerce functionality.

La fintech Nomba et Synafare s'allient pour doter 300 PME nigérianes d'énergie solaire — wearetech.africa, 31

August 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [New investments](#).

Sectoral management information systems

ZAMPORTAL and Teams Enable Lupososhi Official to Print Road Tax Locally — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

ZAMBIA

An official at Lupososhi District Administration in Zambia's Northern Province printed a road-tax document from his own office rather than travelling to Kasama for it, after the Northern Provincial ICT Unit connected the office and ran orientation on Zamportal, Microsoft Teams and Outlook. The report is a single demonstration rather than a rollout figure: how many district offices have been connected, and which Zamportal services they can now transact, are not stated.

Top ICT tenders: Home Affairs expands revenue admin tender — ITWeb South Africa, 31 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's Department of Home Affairs re-advertised its tender for the supply, hosting and support of the revenue administration system that handles collection, reconciliation and Basic Accounting System reporting, replacing June's generic "400+" site count with a two-tier footprint of 275 fixed sites and 230 mobile units. The revision reframes transaction channels around point-of-sale devices and mobile offices rather than the standalone

kiosks and e-Home listed earlier, so bidders must price deployment, licensing and support against a larger and more dispersed estate. Bidding is restricted to suppliers on SITA transversal contract RFB 1183, with a non-compulsory briefing on 4 September and submissions closing 18 September.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Le Gabon s'inspire du modèle rwandais pour accélérer sa transformation numérique — wearetech.africa, 31

August 2026

GABON

RWANDA

Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

South Sudan seeks Huawei support for digitalisation — ITWeb Africa, 31 August 2026

SOUTH SUDAN

South Sudan's minister of information, communication technology and postal services, Ateny Wek Ateny, held exploratory talks with Huawei's vice-president for global public business, Eric Ma, in Hangzhou on the margins of the China-Africa Digital Capacity Building and Cooperation Conference. The government is seeking Huawei's participation in e-governance, smart cities, energy and a national data hub in Juba; the report notes the two sides fell out in 2014, when officials accused the company of hacking government email and forging documents, and dates the repair to a Juba meeting in early 2026. Nothing is committed or costed at this stage. *Also under [China activities](#).*

Smart Africa and Uganda Stakeholders Push Reforms to Boost Digital Entrepreneurship — Tech Africa News, 31

August 2026

UGANDA

Smart Africa and Uganda's Ministry of ICT and National Guidance convened a national validation workshop in Kampala on the findings of Uganda's Digital Entrepreneurship and Innovation Country Assessment. Priorities identified were advancing the Startup Bill, strengthening science and innovation policy, widening access to regulatory sandboxes, and using public procurement to create a market for local startups. The work sits under the Africa-Europe Digital Innovation Bridge (AEDIB 2.0); the assessment itself is not published with the report.

Technology

AI

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NIGERIA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

Huawei Launches Agentic AI Cloud in Nigeria to Accelerate AI Adoption — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [Data Storage](#).

ICT Industry

Africa smartphone market set for sharp 2026 decline — Connecting Africa, 31 August 2026

African smartphone shipments fell 7% year on year in the second quarter, the first decline in three years, with the sub-\$100 segment down 34%. Average selling prices rose \$41 to \$202 as memory costs climbed, and a 26% decline is forecast for 2026. An entry-level handset can cost up to 73% of a low-income adult's monthly income in sub-Saharan Africa. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*

Card-issuing fintech Allawee folds into Paystack after quiet acquisition — TechCabal, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).

Innovation ecosystem

Livraison urbaine : Ebenezer Sasu automatise le transport par drone au Ghana — wearetech.africa, 31 August 2026

GHANA

A profile of Ghanaian aerospace engineer Ebenezer Sasu, founder of Wingextra Aerospace, which since 2019 has combined drones with electric bikes, motorcycles and vans for last-mile delivery in African cities, switching mode automatically on parcel size, distance, urgency and traffic. An allocation and tracking system matches vehicle position and drone status to each order and exposes real-time tracking to customers and merchants. Sasu co-founded OrcaDynamics in 2025, designing drones and aerial systems through 3D modelling and printing.

What 10 years and \$100M taught TLcom about scaling in Africa — TechCabal, 31 August 2026

Summarised under [New investments](#).

Mamor Capital raises R300m for SA tech start-ups — ITWeb South Africa, 31 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

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Mamor Capital raises \$18.8 million first fund — TechCabal, 31 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

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L'entreprise égyptienne Swvl lève des fonds pour s'implanter aux États-Unis — wearetech.africa, 31 August 2026

EGYPT

Summarised under [New investments](#).

Hot startup of the month: Nigeria's Chassis — Connecting Africa, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [Data Storage](#).

Capacity

Training and skills

Yango Expands Fellowship Programme to Six African Countries, Selects 24 STEM Fellows — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

GHANA

ZAMBIA

SENEGAL

ETHIOPIA

MOZAMBIQUE

CÔTE D'IVOIRE

A ride-hailing company's STEM fellowship, begun in Zambia in 2024 with 30 students, has become a six-country programme covering Ghana, Zambia, Senegal, Ethiopia, Mozambique and Cote d'Ivoire. It selected 24 fellows from more than 600 applications, with a graduation and pitch day set for Abidjan on 17-19 September. The 2026 cohort is smaller than the single-country intake it grew from.

NITDA Trains Nigerian Children in Coding, Digital Skills Across Four States — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria's National Information Technology Development Agency closed its 2026 Kids Long Vacation Coding Bootcamp in Kano, Kwara, Jigawa and Gombe, with training still running in the South-South, South-East and South-West. Participants covered coding, computational thinking and digital creativity and received certificates and devices at closing ceremonies; the number of children trained is not given.

MTN Uganda Graduates 503 Young People in Digital Skills Programme — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

UGANDA

MTN Uganda graduated 503 young people from its MTN Ace digital skilling programme at the National ICT Innovation Hub, on a hybrid course covering ICT, digital marketing, e-commerce, cybersecurity and artificial intelligence. The initiative has now trained 1,191 people in total, and the MTN Uganda Foundation put UGX 5.1 billion through its programmes in 2025, which it says reached more than 60,000 people.

MTN South Sudan Launches Aweil ICT Hub to Boost Digital Skills and Youth Innovation — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026

SOUTH SUDAN

MTN South Sudan opened the Aweil ICT Hub in Northern Bahr el Ghazal State, a digital-skills training, scholarship and innovation facility unveiled at a ceremony attended by government, education and development-partner representatives. It is the first hub the record holds outside Juba, and no capacity, budget, term or intake figure is published. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

Beyond Access: Advancing Digital Agency for People with Visual Impairments in Malawi — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP Malawi), 31 August 2026

MALAWI

A second cohort of an introductory computer course for people with visual impairments ran at the Malawi School of Government, training participants as master trainers rather than as beneficiaries alone - among them a secondary-school teacher and a senior labour officer. No commitment, disbursement or budget figure for the project behind it is stated. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

Nigeria Pushes Sovereign AI Agenda at GITEX 2026 — Voice of Nigeria, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

Inclusion

Access to services

Nigeria wants more assistive tech. Who is fixing its inaccessible digital platforms? — TechCabal, 31 August 2026

NIGERIA

The Nigerian Communications Commission ran its fourth Hackathon Live Show in Abuja on 26 and 27 August under the theme "Technology Without Barriers", producing prototypes for speech-to-text, real-time sign-language translation, voice-enabled complaints and image-to-voice navigation. TechCabal sets that against the platforms Nigerians are already expected to use: NITDA's guidelines require government websites to meet the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines, and the Nigeria Web Design Standards toolkit promised for public feedback within 8 to 10 weeks of its July 2025 launch could not be found published, nor any evidence of Federal Executive Council approval or rollout — while the communications ministry's 2025 Year in Review still lists the launch as an achievement. The National Commission for Persons with Disabilities estimates 35 million Nigerians have disabilities.

NSSF and Airtel Money Renew Partnership to Expand Voluntary Savings in Uganda — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026 UGANDA

Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).

MTN South Sudan Launches Aweil ICT Hub to Boost Digital Skills and Youth Innovation — Tech Africa News, 31 August 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

Summarised under [Training and skills](#).

Beyond Access: Advancing Digital Agency for People with Visual Impairments in Malawi — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP Malawi), 31 August 2026 MALAWI

Summarised under [Training and skills](#).

Digital divides

Africa smartphone market set for sharp 2026 decline — Connecting Africa, 31 August 2026

Summarised under [ICT Industry](#).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Internet par satellite : Starlink cible 16 nouveaux marchés africains d'ici fin 2026 — Agence Ecofin, 31 August 2026

MAURITANIA MALI GAMBIA GUINEA BURKINA FASO TOGO TUNISIA UGANDA TANZANIA
COMOROS NAMIBIA ANGOLA CONGO GABON CAMEROON MAURITIUS

Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

China activities

Xinhua Headlines: China promotes coordinated development of data industry, artificial intelligence — Xinhua News Agency (Belt and Road Portal), 31 August 2026

Xinhua's report on the 2026 China International Big Data Industry Expo in Guiyang profiles Wazisana, a blockchain platform launched two years ago by Zimbabwean entrepreneur Dubuya Thulani, which requires African farmers to upload video of their production process for AI to turn into product descriptions for Chinese buyers. Thulani says coffee, red wine and avocados have been exported through it and the business is profitable; no volumes, participating countries or farmer numbers are given.

South Sudan seeks Huawei support for digitalisation — ITWeb Africa, 31 August 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

Summarised under [Rural digital data capture](#).

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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